

SWAMPS AND MARSHES



Pied avocet



Half water, half land, swamps and marshes are strange places to live. But to thousands of birds, the shallow water and soggy soil is an ideal home—it is full of food. Birds that live in these tree-filled swamps or murky marshes can either walk through the water or swim. Those

that walk are called waders. Wading birds have long, thin legs, sometimes thinner than a pencil!



To keep their eggs and chicks dry, reed warblers build their nests high up in the reeds, well above the water.

Young scarlet ibises have gray feathers. They only grow red feathers when they are several years old.



Black tip to the long, red wing



Highly strung

Foxes and other egg-thieves can't walk on marshy ground. So, to keep their family safe, reed warblers build their homes in tall marsh plants, called reeds. The nest is tied tightly onto the reeds and won't fall down, even on a windy day.

This is not a knee, but an ankle!

Scarlet ibises are about 18 inches (46 centimeters) tall and live in swamps in South America.

